



Web trackers: A menace

There are about 1300 tracking websites, noting your every single online move. What do they know? <http://dgit.in/1078MKM>

DuckTales game remastered

That's right. Capcom is bringing back the original NES game later this summer on Wii U, PSN and XBLA for \$15 <http://dgit.in/ZUECdR>

quencies this headphone messes with, but the vocals sound a bit strange. While the headphone scored very well on our guitar test track (While My Guitar Gently Weeps – Santana feat. India Arie) the vocals went for a toss, sounding flat. Certainly India Arie isn't nasal? So despite the score, it takes away from the overall experience. Sonically, it sounds very similar to the Martin Logan, but the Micros 90 is more balanced towards the neutral side. Its design, performance, features (like daisy chaining other headphones, colourful bundled changeable earpads) and overall score make it our Best Buy for this category.

The others

Next up, we have the beautiful sound piece from Martin Logan, the **Micros 90**. Covered in black leather and with nice chrome accents this one is certainly a looker. And in the case of these over-the-ear cans we can't even say beauty is skin deep. The sound is balanced, bright and the bass is tight and accurate. But placing it perfectly over the ear for a good seal is very important in getting the best sound from this device. Another major complaint is the clamping pressure. The tight seal that we spoke of necessitates extreme clamping pressure. If Skullcandy hadn't taken the Skullcrusher brand name, Martin Logan could've easily taken it. Aurally the **Ferrari R200** and the Micros 90 are in the same league. What the R200 lacks slightly in detail it makes up with a well-rounded sound signature that is decidedly bass heavy. Other than that both cans have on wire three-button controls and cables that aren't really up to the mark. The only wireless headphone to feature in this Audiophile category was the

Sennheiser RS 220. The headphone performed so badly that we're in a quandary whether it was a damaged unit that was shipped to us. The entire mid-range was muddled and the bass was distorting badly. Sadly the show must go on and it shows in the results. Perhaps we'll call for another unit to double check.

₹5,000 to ₹12,000 AKG K271 MK II

Starting this category with a crackle and pop is the K271 MKII – a true blue reference set from the AKG stables. Being studio monitors they've got what you've by now come to expect from cans in this class – long replaceable and superlative comfort. Apart from this there is an auto-off mechanism which switches off the music as soon as you take them off. We spent a couple of minutes trying to figure out exactly how this works and jumped from theories of proximity sensors to finally what turned out to be a small little switch attached to the headband which does the trick. As for the sound signature, it's fairly neutral for the

most part but when it comes to bass these cans are pretty shy. The vocals are right up front coming through fairly crystal clear but the rest of the spectrum is flat. The result is that the music feels very empty. And now here's the kicker – the cheaper K240 MK II performed better than this beefier sibling. How and why? Find out below.

AKG K240 MKII

The K240 comes from the same pedigree that has crafted the 271, except for a few design changes. For one, the K240 is semi-open unlike K271 which is fully closed. Plus these are tuned for better bass reproduction. The semi-open design makes them sound better, not as a studio monitoring set, but certainly for your day-to-day Audiophile needs they're much better. On a side note we sorely missed the Audio Technica M50 particularly when testing these cans. We had it with us for a few months in 2012. Sweet nostalgia.

Blaupunkt Comfort

The CN-112 is decidedly bass heavy and perhaps the most warm sounding headphone in the test. The thing with warm sound signature is that it renders vocals pretty well, so without a flat response headphone around for comparison they'll sound perfectly "nice" to the average listener. Why wouldn't they? You get nice vocals, the bass isn't bad, but you lose out the fineries in the upper spectrum. That sharp crunch on the guitar, the pinch harmonic wail or even a sibilant high-cymbal. All that is necessary. Without the ANC on, it seems as though the entire frequency range beyond 100 Hz is suppressed. Of the two Blaupunkt headphones the Comfort CN-112 is the more mellow



Harman Kardon CL

sounding one. And mellow usually means less detailed.

Harman Kardon CL

The CL moniker on these cans presumably stands for classic. The sandblasted steel headband, pads that adjust to the size of your head and pillowy earpads all give it a nice old school yet functional look. (Yes we know it's not really a word, but you get the picture). The headphone has a particularly sweet sound signature. You'll especially relish these if you're preference in music is guitar driven rock. By and large supra-aural headphones have a tough time competing with circumaurals in terms of comfort, but these cans are extremely comfortable even over extended listening. Bass is accurate and just the right amount over the standard flat response neutral headphones. This is certainly a headphone worth the asking price, making it our Best Buy in this category.

The others

Rounding off this category are two rather strange headphones.



AKG K99